

CostView — Site Operations PRD

What this covers: Budget, Procurement, Materials, Labour, Progress, Subcontractors, Variations, Reports, Admin, Help. Not covered: Commercial mode (Contractor/Developer toggle).

Why this document exists: to tell developers, in plain terms, what each screen shows, where every number comes from, what the system should do on its own, and what a person still needs to do by hand — including everything the current prototype shows but doesn't actually let you do yet.

The one rule behind everything below: let the system calculate whatever it honestly can. A person only gets involved to (1) type in something the system has no way of knowing — a name, a decision, a brand-new item — or (2) approve/reject something the system has already flagged for them. Nobody should be typing numbers the system could work out itself, and nothing should sit stuck waiting on a person unless it's genuinely an exception.

1. Budget

1.1 Overview

Just a dashboard. Every number on it is pulled from the tabs below. Nobody types anything here.

1.2 BOQ — this is where real data enters the system

Someone uploads their BOQ, material list, labour list, or rebar schedule in whatever format they already have — Excel, Word, even a scanned PDF. The AI reads it and sorts it into the right columns (Item, Description, Qty, Unit, Rate, Amount). Before anything gets saved, the person reviews what the AI pulled out, fixes anything it got wrong, and confirms — only then does it go live.

Every item gets a unique code so it can be linked to its material, labour, and rebar costs elsewhere in the system. Actual cost, budget vs. actual variance, and status (On Budget / Over / Under) all calculate themselves from there.

Two things get added once, per item, at the start: **who's expected to finish it and by when**, and **who's responsible for it**.

Still missing: a way to manually add a BOQ item (for anything the import missed), a way to edit or delete a row, and the confirm-before-saving step described above.

1.3 Forecast — fully automatic, nothing to type

Works out where the project's costs are heading based on what's actually happened so far, plus what's left to do at the rate it's currently costing. Shows expected total cost, how far that is from budget, how confident that number is, and when the project is likely to finish — compared against the planned finish date, so you can see if you're ahead or behind. Nothing here needs manual entry, and nothing is missing.

1.4 Cost Control — fully automatic, nothing to type

Shows how efficiently money is being spent against how much work is actually done, flags anything trending over budget, and shows who's responsible for each item.

Still missing: a way to mark a flagged risk as "seen/handled" once someone's dealt with it.

1.5 Revisions — a person creates it, the system applies it

A Revision is a real, approved change to the budget — always tied to something that actually happened: an approved Variation, a rate that was wrong, or a client-instructed change.

Still missing, entirely: a button to add a new Revision (what changed, why, the ₦ amount, which BOQ item it affects); an automatic pre-filled entry whenever a Variation gets approved, so nobody has to retype it; and an Approve/Reject action on each one. Only an approved Revision should actually change the budget — and once it does, that change should flow through to Forecast, Cost Control, and Final Account on its own.

1.6 Final Account — fully automatic, and reconciliation never gets stuck

Compares the original budget against what was actually spent, item by item. **Every item reconciles automatically** — a variance never holds that up. If there's a gap, it's shown right next to the "Reconciled" tag (e.g. "Reconciled — Variance: +₦410,000"), and it shows up in management reports too, not hidden anywhere.

Still missing: a simple way for the QS to leave a note on a flagged variance (wastage, theft, a negotiated rate — whatever the reason is) for the record. This is just a note for the audit trail — it never changes the Reconciled status.

2. Procurement

The chain here is: **Requisition → Supplier Enquiry → Purchase Order → Delivery →**

Invoice → Payment, plus a Supplier Performance score built from all of it. Each document remembers which document it came from, so you can always trace the whole trail back.

2.1 Overview

Dashboard only, pulled from the tabs below.

2.2 Requisitions

Gets created two ways: automatically (when material stock runs low) or manually (a Site Engineer needs something for site).

Still missing: a “New Requisition” form for the manual path, and an Approve/Reject action.

2.3 Supplier Enquiries

Sent out to suppliers for pricing, responses compared side by side, then converted straight into a Purchase Order.

Still missing: a way to actually create a new enquiry, and every action button on this screen (Add Supplier, Compare Quotes, Select Supplier, Convert to PO, etc.) needs to actually work — right now they just sit there.

2.4 Purchase Orders

Created from a converted Enquiry (or directly).

Still missing: a proper approval step before it goes to the supplier — right now it jumps straight from “created” to “supplier accepted” with nobody signing off in between. Also needs a way to pick how payment works for this order — pay first, pay after delivery, or partial upfront — since that decides whether an invoice can be raised before delivery happens.

2.5 Deliveries

Same record as the GRN in Materials — it shouldn’t be entered twice in two places. Delivered quantity is checked against the order automatically, and any shortfall gets flagged.

Still missing: a real “Verify Delivery” / “Resolve Discrepancy” action — right now it’s just a static screen.

2.6 Invoices

Matched against the Purchase Order (and the delivery, once there is one). The system checks all three match up and flags anything that doesn’t.

Still missing: a way to actually log a new invoice, and working buttons for flagging a discrepancy, requesting a credit note, and downloading.

2.7 Payments

Tracks back through Invoice → Order → Delivery. Needs to support paying in advance when that's the agreed terms.

Still missing: "Process Payment" and "Hold Payment" need to actually do something — record how it was paid, when, and update the invoice status.

2.8 Supplier Performance

On-time delivery and pricing can be worked out automatically from order/delivery/invoice history.

Still missing: quality is a judgment call, not something the system can work out on its own — needs a simple "Rate This Delivery" action for whoever receives the goods, which then feeds the supplier's score over time.

3. Materials

Handled by the Site Engineer, acting as storekeeper for this section (same person, no separate role needed).

3.1 Inventory

Shows stock levels and status (Healthy / Low / Out) per material. Read-only overview, click into any item for detail. Nothing missing here.

3.2 GRN (delivery record)

Created automatically when a Purchase Order is approved — nobody types this in by hand. The person's job is just to confirm the count matches, or flag it if it doesn't. Nothing missing.

3.3 Consumption (material sent to site)

Flags automatically if more is used than the work should have needed.

Still missing: a way to actually record a new consumption entry — right now you can only confirm or reverse ones that already exist.

3.4 Returns

Always linked back to the delivery it came from. Person decides: restock, dispose, or reject. Nothing missing — this correctly starts from an existing record, not a blank form.

3.5 Transfers

Moving stock between sites/stores.

Still missing: a "Create Transfer" button — right now there's no way to start one.

3.6 Stock Count

Pulls the list of what to count automatically from Inventory. Person counts, system compares against what it expects, differences get reviewed. Nothing missing.

4. Labour

Two tabs only.

4.1 Payroll

Still missing: a way to add a worker (name, trade, pay period, daily rate) — this is the actual starting point for the whole module and it doesn't exist yet.

4.2 Timesheets

Pulls from whoever's already in Payroll — nothing separately typed here. Tracks hours and overtime, with an approval trail. Nothing missing.

5. Progress

5.1 Diary

Day-by-day site journal. Right now you can only add an entry inside a day that's already been started.

Still missing: a way to start a brand-new day/entry from scratch.

5.2 Photos

A gallery of everything attached in Diary.

Still missing: a direct way to upload a photo — right now the only way in is through a Diary entry.

5.3 Inspections

Still missing: a way to add a new inspection — right now you can only view existing ones.

5.4 Snags (defects to fix)

Correctly created only from an inspection ("Raise Snag") — not something typed from scratch. Nothing missing.

5.5 Safety

Right now this is just a static list — no way to add anything, no way to click in for detail.

Still missing: a way to log a new safety observation or incident. As it stands, this tab can't actually be used.

5.6 Quality

Non-conformance reports get raised automatically from a failed inspection — correctly not something typed from scratch. Nothing missing.

6. Subcontractors

6.1 Contracts

This should be where a subcontractor first gets added to the project.

Still missing: a way to add a subcontractor — their name, trade, what they're doing on site, contract value, retention held. Clicking into one should show their real financial summary, not a placeholder.

6.2 Claims

A claim is what a subcontractor submits for work done.

Still missing: a way to log a new claim — subcontractor, period, amount, what it's for.

6.3 Certificates

This is the output once a claim is certified — view and download only, which is correct. It just needs to actually pull from a real certified claim instead of showing static examples.

6.4 Payments

The ledger here — what's been paid, what's held as retention — should build itself from Claims and Certificates, not be typed separately.

6.5 Performance

Right now it just shows a fixed score with nothing behind it.

Still missing: a way to actually grade a subcontractor across the four things that matter — quality of work, keeping to schedule, safety, responsiveness — so the score means something and updates over time, instead of being a fixed number.

7. Variations

Order these tabs: Instructions first, then Register, then Approval Workflow, then Cost Impact — since an instruction is usually what triggers a variation in the first place.

7.1 Instructions

Still missing: a way to log a new instruction (who issued it, when, what it says), which can then be linked to a variation once one is raised from it.

7.2 Register

The master list of variations.

Still missing: a way to raise a new variation — who raised it, what it's for, which instruction (if any) it's linked to, which BOQ item it affects.

7.3 Approval Workflow

Draft → QS values it → PM reviews it → Approved. (No separate client-approval stage — PM approval is the final internal step.)

Still missing: real buttons to move a variation through each stage — right now the board just shows numbers with nothing to click.

7.4 Cost Impact

Fully automatic — once QS has valued a variation, the totals (additions, omissions, net impact) and the chart calculate themselves. Nothing typed here.

Once approved: the system should automatically create a pre-filled Revision in Budget, so

nobody has to retype it there.

8. Reports

One of the most important sections — this is where everything gets reconciled and reviewed.

Every report needs a project picker at the top — look at one project, or all of them combined.

What's needed here, kept simple: basic financial summaries a person can pull up whenever they want to check how the numbers are doing — budget vs. actual, what's been spent, what's committed, what's left, cash position. Whatever cost question someone has, there should be a report that answers it, with real figures and tables, not vague summaries. A site progress report, built from the Diary/Inspections/Quality data, with actual numbers in it — not just a narrative.

Nothing to type here — Reports is entirely a read/export layer on top of everything already entered elsewhere. The only thing missing is that it needs to actually show real detail and let you pick which project(s) to look at — right now it's too thin.

9. Admin

- **Permissions** — someone with admin access decides who can see and do what. This one genuinely has to stay manual — access is a judgment call, not something the system can decide on its own.
- **Audit Log** — right now it's just a scrolling feed.

Still missing: turn it into a proper searchable table — who did what, in which module, when, and what changed — so if someone needs to trace a specific event on a specific day, they can actually search for it instead of scrolling.

10. Help

A plain-language walkthrough of the whole platform, plus a phone number/email for anyone who's stuck and needs a person. Nothing calculated here — it's just a guide.

Full List of What's Missing — One Place

#	Where	What needs adding
1	Budget → BOQ	Manual "Add Item" + edit/delete + review-before-saving step
2	Budget → Cost Control	Mark a risk alert as handled
3	Budget → Revisions	"Add Revision" button + Approve/Reject
4	Budget → Final Account	A note field on flagged variances
5	Procurement → Requisitions	"New Requisition" form + Approve/Reject
6	Procurement → Supplier Enquiries	"New Enquiry" + working buttons
7	Procurement → Purchase Orders	Approval step + payment-terms field
8	Procurement → Deliveries	"Verify Delivery" / "Resolve Discrepancy"
9	Procurement → Invoices	"New Invoice" + working buttons
10	Procurement → Payments	"Process Payment" / "Hold Payment"
11	Procurement → Supplier Performance	"Rate This Delivery"
12	Materials → Consumption	"Record Consumption"
13	Materials → Transfers	"Create Transfer"
14	Labour → Payroll	"Add Worker"
15	Progress → Diary	"New Day/Entry" from scratch
16	Progress → Photos	Direct "Upload Photo"
17	Progress → Inspections	"Add Inspection"
18	Progress → Safety	"Add Observation/Incident" (currently unusable)
19	Subcontractors → Contracts	"Add Subcontractor" + real detail view
20	Subcontractors → Claims	"Add Claim"

21	Subcontractors → Performance	A real grading interface, four categories
22	Variations → Instructions	"Add Instruction"
23	Variations → Register	"Add Variation"
24	Variations → Approval Workflow	Working stage buttons
25	Reports	Project picker + real figures (currently too thin)
26	Admin → Audit Log	Rebuild as a searchable table

Two Things Still To Confirm

1. **Budget status threshold** — how far off budget before an item is marked "Over" or "Under" instead of "On Budget"? Suggesting $\pm 5\%$ as a starting point, but this is your call.
2. **Reports detail** — this document lists the report types needed (budget vs. actual, cash position, what's spent/committed/left). The exact layout and fields inside each one is worth a dedicated follow-up once you've had a chance to look at the report types you actually use day to day.